

City University of Hong Kong
Course Syllabus

offered by Department of Information Systems
with effect from Semester A 2018 / 2019

Part I Course Overview

Course Title: Building Personal and Firm Images in the Digital Society

Course Code: GE1212

Course Duration: One Semester (13 weeks)

Credit Units: 3

Level: B1

☐ Arts and Humanities

Proposed Area:
(for GE courses only)

☒ **Study of Societies, Social and Business Organisations**

☐ Science and Technology

Medium of Instruction: English

Medium of Assessment: English

Prerequisites:
(Course Code and Title) Nil

Precursors:
(Course Code and Title) Nil

Equivalent Courses:
(Course Code and Title) Nil

Exclusive Courses:
(Course Code and Title) Nil

Part II Course Details

1. Abstract

(A 150-word description about the course)

The exciting arrival of digital platform (e.g., online and mobile advertising, social networking websites like Facebook, and government e-portals) has changed how we interact with each other and how the society of communication is shaped. The proliferation of digital platform brings upon opportunities as well as challenges to our lives. Through this highly interactive course, we will take the students through a structured examination of how we are affected by and/or could leverage on the digital platform to better present ourselves and to improve the society well-being at large. Students will learn to appreciate the opportunities that new digital platform brings to organizations for branding, and to individuals for improving their images for their personal career and life, as well to the society and community in terms of the social well-being. On the other hand, as the new platform will not simply replace the traditional ones (e.g., face-to-face, papers, TV), students will learn how to deliver a seamless profile across multiple platforms. Social responsibility of using new platform is also discussed.

2. Course Intended Learning Outcomes (CILOs)

(CILOs state what the student is expected to be able to do at the end of the course according to a given standard of performance.)

No.	CILOs [#]	Weighting* (if applicable)	Discovery-enriched curriculum related learning outcomes (please tick where appropriate)		
			A1	A2	A3
1.	Describe the evolution of digital platform.	10%	✓		
2.	Analyze the impacts of digital platform on culture, organization activities, social groups and individuals; evaluate the consequences for communication practices in modern society.	30%	✓	✓	
3.	Design and develop campaigns to leverage media technologies for personal image profiling and/or firm branding, with an emphasis on ethics and social responsibility.	30%	✓	✓	✓
4.	Communicate the purpose and specifics of the campaigns to stakeholders.	10%	✓	✓	✓
5.	Critically evaluate and reflect on an individual's role in the society influenced by the ubiquity of digital platform.	20%	✓	✓	
		100%			

* If weighting is assigned to CILOs, they should add up to 100%.

[#] Please specify the alignment of CILOs to the Gateway Education Programme Intended Learning outcomes (PILOs) in Section A of Annex.

A1: Attitude

Develop an attitude of discovery/innovation/creativity, as demonstrated by students possessing a strong sense of curiosity, asking questions actively, challenging assumptions or engaging in inquiry together with teachers.

A2: Ability

Develop the ability/skill needed to discover/innovate/create, as demonstrated by students possessing critical thinking skills to assess ideas, acquiring research skills, synthesizing knowledge across disciplines or applying academic knowledge to self-life problems.

A3: Accomplishments

Demonstrate accomplishment of discovery/innovation/creativity through producing /constructing creative works/new artefacts, effective solutions to real-life problems or new processes.

3. Teaching and Learning Activities (TLAs)

(TLAs designed to facilitate students' achievement of the CILOs.)

TLA	Brief Description	CILO No.					Hours/week (if applicable)
		1	2	3	4	5	
TLA1. Lectures	Key concepts, frameworks and examples of digital platform's role will be explained through lectures.	✓	✓			✓	Seminar: 3 Hours/Week
TLA2. In-Class Exercise	Students are encouraged to relate the concepts in class to their personal experience in written or oral format in class. Students are highly encouraged to share their views and reflection on his/her role in the society fuelled by the digital platforms.	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	
TLA3. Digital Platform Project	Students are required to apply the concepts in class to market events, perform critical self-reflection (for individual profiling) or comparative analysis (for firm branding) so as to effectively profile themselves through various media technologies, and be recognized as an ethical and socially responsible individual/firm.	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	
TLA4. Online Discussion	Students can do self-reflection, peer discussion, knowledge sharing and raise questions.	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	

4. Assessment Tasks/Activities (ATs)

(ATs are designed to assess how well the students achieve the CILOs.)

Assessment Tasks/Activities	CILO No.					Weighting*	Remarks [#]
	1	2	3	4	5		
Continuous Assessment: <u>100%</u>							
AT1. In-Class Exercises: Each lab includes in-class exercises in the format of small group discussions, hands-on exercises, games, self-reflection, and/or student presentations to assess students' understanding of the taught topics and their abilities to apply their skills.	✓	✓	✓			20%	
AT2. Individual Assignment: Students are to 1) do self-reflection on his/her role played in the society and how he/she could better profile and protect one's self; or 2) do research on and provide suggestions to improve real firm's image in the face of ubiquitous presence of digital platform. This is an individual mark.		✓			✓	10%	

AT3. Group Project: Create and maintain a digital group. Assessment will entail 1) initial proposal (10%), and 2) final report and presentation (20%). Individual contribution and role played (weighted).		✓	✓	✓		30%	
Examination: 40% (duration: one 2-hour exam)							
AT4. Final Examination: A written examination is developed to assess student's competence level of the taught subjects.	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	40%	
* The weightings should add up to 100%.						100%	

Remark: Students must pass BOTH coursework and examination in order to get an overall pass in this course.

5. Assessment Rubrics

(Grading of student achievements is based on student performance in assessment tasks/activities with the following rubrics.)

Assessment Task	Criterion	Excellent (A+, A, A-)	Good (B+, B, B-)	Fair (C+, C, C-)	Marginal (D)	Failure (F)
AT1. In-Class Exercises	Ability to describe the evolution of digital platform.	High	Significant	Moderate	Basic	Not even reaching marginal levels
	Ability to analyze the impacts of digital platform on culture, organization activities, social groups and individuals; evaluate the consequences for communication practices in modern society.	High	Significant	Moderate	Basic	Not even reaching marginal levels
	Ability to design and develop campaigns to leverage media technologies for personal image profiling and/or firm branding, with an emphasis on ethics and social responsibility.	High	Significant	Moderate	Basic	Not even reaching marginal levels
AT2. Individual Assignment	Ability to analyze the impacts of digital platform on culture, organization activities, social groups and individuals; evaluate the consequences for communication practices in modern society.	High	Significant	Moderate	Basic	Not even reaching marginal levels
	Ability to critically evaluate and reflect on an individual's role in the society influenced by the ubiquity of digital platform.	High	Significant	Moderate	Basic	Not even reaching marginal levels

AT3. Group Project	Ability to analyze the impacts of digital platform on culture, organization activities, social groups and individuals; evaluate the consequences for communication practices in modern society.	High	Significant	Moderate	Basic	Not even reaching marginal levels
	Ability to design and develop campaigns to leverage media technologies for personal image profiling and/or firm branding, with an emphasis on ethics and social responsibility.	High	Significant	Moderate	Basic	Not even reaching marginal levels
	Ability to communicate the purpose and specifics of the campaigns to stakeholders.	High	Significant	Moderate	Basic	Not even reaching marginal levels
AT4. Final Examination	Ability to describe the evolution of digital platform.	High	Significant	Moderate	Basic	Not even reaching marginal levels
	Ability to analyze the impacts of digital platform on culture, organization activities, social groups and individuals; evaluate the consequences for communication practices in modern society.	High	Significant	Moderate	Basic	Not even reaching marginal levels
	Ability to design and develop campaigns to leverage media technologies for personal image profiling and/or firm branding, with an emphasis on ethics and social responsibility.	High	Significant	Moderate	Basic	Not even reaching marginal levels
	Ability to communicate the purpose and specifics of the campaigns to stakeholders.	High	Significant	Moderate	Basic	Not even reaching marginal levels
	Ability to critically evaluate and reflect on an individual's role in the society influenced by the ubiquity of digital platform.	High	Significant	Moderate	Basic	Not even reaching marginal levels

Part III Other Information (more details can be provided separately in the teaching plan)

1. Keyword Syllabus

(An indication of the key topics of the course.)

1. Digital platform and technology evolution – web 2.0 (e.g., microblog) and mobile applications (e.g., iPad)
2. Digital platform and culture - national culture and sub-culture
3. Digital platform and organizations (e.g., business firms, e-government, NGOs) – legislation and institution, public relation and branding
4. Digital platform with individuals and society – online consumer psychology, personal profiling, risk and protection
5. Integrated profiling across multiple platforms – manage communications in both new digital platform and traditional platform, select an ideal medium
6. Professionalism and good citizenship – cyber etiquette, abuse of technology, and proper manners that help maintain harmonious society both online and offline

2. Reading List

2.1 Compulsory Readings

(Compulsory readings can include books, book chapters, or journal/magazine articles. There are also collections of e-books, e-journals available from the CityU Library.)

1.	Tuten, Tracy L., and Michael R. Solomon, <u>Social Media Marketing</u> , Sage, 2014.
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2.2 Additional Readings

(Additional references for students to learn to expand their knowledge about the subject.)

1.	Beth Kanter and Allison Fine, <u>The Networked Nonprofit: Connecting with Social Media to Drive Change</u> , Jossey-Bass, 2010.
2.	Lilie Chouliaraki and Mette Morsing, <u>Media, Organizations and Identity</u> , Palgrave Macmillan, 2010.
3.	Fraser P. Seitel, <u>Practice of Public Relations</u> , 2010.
4.	Jim Sterne, <u>Social Media Metrics</u> , 2010.
5.	Scott Kirsner, Fans, Friends And Followers: <u>Building An Audience And A Creative Career In The Digital Age</u> , 2009.
6.	Matthew Hindman, <u>The Myth of Digital Democracy</u> , 2009.
7.	Everette E. Dennis and Melvin L. DeFleur, <u>Understanding Media in the Digital Age</u> , 2009.
8.	Brian Halligan, Dharmesh Shah and Dharmesh Shah, <u>Inbound Marketing: Get Found Using Google, Social Media, and Blogs</u> , 2009.
9.	Rudi Volti, <u>Society and Technological Change</u> , 2009.
10.	Henry Jenkins, <u>Convergence Culture: Where Old and New Media Collide</u> , 2008.
11.	Karen Mossberger, Caroline J. Tolbert and Ramona S. McNeal, <u>Digital Citizenship: The Internet, Society and Participation</u> , 2007.

2.3 Online Resources

Due to rapid changes in the digital platform, regular and periodical changes in the reading and study materials will be anticipated. Thus, course reading materials will be augmented by articles from journals, whitepapers and other materials available on-line.

- A. Please specify the Gateway Education Programme Intended Learning Outcomes (PILOs) that the course is aligned to and relate them to the CILOs stated in Part II, Section 2 of this form:

GE PILO	Please indicate which CILO(s) is/are related to this PILO, if any (can be more than one CILOs in each PILO)
PILO 1: Demonstrate the capacity for self-directed learning	CILO1 – the students are given opportunities to assess the various digital technologies and learn how to harness on them for self-directed interest (e.g., image and profile development).
PILO 2: Explain the basic methodologies and techniques of inquiry of the arts and humanities, social sciences, business, and science and technology	CILO1, CILO2 – the students are introduced to various contemporary digital technologies and media with additional focus on analyzing their impacts on cultural and societal activities.
PILO 3: Demonstrate critical thinking skills	CILO2, CILO5 – the students are trained and given opportunity to apply what they are taught to critically assess and reflect on their current digital image, and derive plans (e.g., campaigns) to improve it.
PILO 4: Interpret information and numerical data	CILO2 – the students are required, for exercises, to gather and critically analyze the information online.
PILO 5: Produce structured, well-organised and fluent text	CILO3, CILO4 – the students are required to structure their thoughts on image and profile development and how such profiling campaign proposal could aid individual and organization.
PILO 6: Demonstrate effective oral communication skills	CILO3, CILO4 – the students are required to present their project orally to the class.
PILO 7: Demonstrate an ability to work effectively in a team	CILO4 - we are expecting certain degree of group interaction arising from the project.
PILO 8: Recognise important characteristics of their own culture(s) and at least one other culture, and their impact on global issues	
PILO 9: Value ethical and socially responsible actions	CILO2 – the students are taught and assessed on the impacts of digital platform in ethics and social responsibilities.
PILO 10: Demonstrate the attitude and/or ability to accomplish discovery and/or innovation	CILO1, CILO2 and CILO3 – the students are taught and assessed on how they derive strategies to project a positive image of themselves and the responsible organization.

GE course leaders should cover the mandatory PILOs for the GE area (Area 1: Arts and Humanities; Area 2: Study of Societies, Social and Business Organisations; Area 3: Science and Technology) for which they have classified their course; for quality assurance purposes, they are advised to carefully consider if it is beneficial to claim any coverage of additional PILOs. General advice would be to restrict PILOs to only the essential ones. (Please refer to the curricular mapping of GE programme: http://www.cityu.edu.hk/edge/ge/faculty/curricular_mapping.htm.)

- B. Please select an assessment task for collecting evidence of student achievement for quality assurance purposes. Please retain at least one sample of student achievement across a period of three years.

Selected Assessment Task
AT3. Group Project